

SERENA CAO

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EDUCATION

The New School - Parsons School of Design
Master's, Design and Technology

August 2022 - May 2024
GPA: 3.77

University of Florida
Bachelor's, Digital Arts and Sciences

- Minor in Computer Science and Engineering

August 2018 - May 2022
GPA: 3.8

WORK EXPERIENCE

GBK Parts

Digital Media Designer, E-commerce & Digital Marketing

February 2026 - Present
New York, NY, USA

- Led the 0 to 1 digital transformation of a traditional B2B company, building its first online brand store, website, product catalog, and marketplace-ready sales system across wholesale and retail channels.
- Built GBK's brand and creative system across marketplace listing images, Amazon content, product videos, packaging, trade-show collateral, and email campaigns; produced digital assets using Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Canva, and AI-assisted workflows, reducing production time by up to 50%.
- Drove digital marketing execution and optimization through GA4, refining landing pages, email campaigns, product content, and buyer-facing assets to improve searchability, trust, and lead generation.

Kogna.io

Design Engineer & Product Designer

February 2026 - Present
Remote

- Designed and productized the end-to-end Kogna Insights experience, transforming fragmented data from tools such as Tableau, Jira, and shared files into an intuitive dashboard of actionable Smart Tiles that helped leaders connect operational activity with shifting business metrics, risks, and opportunities.
- Conceptualized, prototyped, and implemented responsive web and mobile experiences using Figma, Claude Code, and the production codebase that kept the design system and shipped product aligned.

Forestar Technology

Ecommerce Operation Specialist

February 2025 - February 2026
New York, NY, USA

- Design responsive livestream layouts and content hierarchy aligned with promotional goals, improve viewer retention by 15% through A/B testing and data-driven iterations.
- Increase GMV by 20% and CTR by 12% through TikTok Shop optimization; manage product listings, create high-converting visual content, and analyze livestream metrics to iterate campaign performance.

Alibaba Group

Product Designer

December 2020 - May 2022
Remote

- Designed and launched anime and gaming IP merchandise product lines from concept to market, partnering with 200+ independent artists to create collectibles, toys, and lifestyle goods resonating with Gen Z collector community.
- Created brand visual identity and marketing assets that built engaged community of 60K+ users, achieving 85%+ sell-through rate and strong customer loyalty through design-driven storytelling.

PROJECTS & PORTFOLIO HIGHLIGHTS

Spark Up | AI-Powered Entrepreneurial Platform
Product Designer

September 2025 - January 2026
New York, NY, USA

- Led end-to-end product design from concept to high-fidelity UI, creating intuitive interfaces for complex AI-powered features through user research, wireframes, and prototyping.
- Built full-stack application using React + TypeScript frontend, Python backend, and Claude API integration—implemented Firebase authentication, AWS deployment via Terraform, and bilingual i18n support (English/Chinese).
- [Link to project](#)

SKILLS

Skills: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, UI/UX Design, 3D Modeling (Blender, Autodesk Maya), User Journey Mapping, Wireframing & Prototyping, A/B Testing

Soft Skills: Leadership, Self-starter, Problem Solving, Communication

AI Skills: Vibe Coding, AI-Accelerated Development, AI Tools (Cursor, Claude Code, ChatGPT)